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FOR VICTORY BUY UNITED STATES WAR BONDS AND STAMPS

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THE JOINT CHIEFS OF STAFF
WASHINGTON 25, D. C.

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SM-3143
30 August 1945.

MEMORANDUM FOR THE STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE:

Subject: Directive concerning policy and operations in China after Japanese capitulation.

In its memorandum of 10 August 1945 the State-War-Navy Coordinating Committee suggested that the Commanding General, U.S. Forces, China Theater, be informed that provision should be made that the Government of China effect the disposal of captured and/or surrendered enemy material and personnel only in collaboration with the other nations engaged in the war against Japan, and subject to any over-all principles that may be adopted by them.

The Joint Chiefs of Staff are not of the opinion that the Commanding General, U.S. Forces, China Theater, is in a proper position to influence the Government of China to accept the proposed policy for disposal of enemy material and personnel. The present precarious and complex political situation in China resulting from the strained relations between the Central Government and the Chinese Communists is such that any instructions to General Wedemeyer to obtain Chinese agreement to the proposed policy might be wrongly construed by the Chinese Central Government since the policy could not be concurrently imposed on the Chinese Communists. As no agreements have yet been reached between the governments of the United States, Great Britain, the U.S.S.R. and China on the matter of the disposition of captured equipment, the Joint Chiefs of Staff suggest (1) that instructions proposed in paragraph 2 of the memorandum of 10 August not be sent to General Wedemeyer at the present time, and (2) that the matter be given further consideration by the State-War-Navy Coordinating Committee.

For the Joint Chiefs of Staff:

A. J. McFARLAND,
Brigadier General, U.S.A.,
Secretary.

Enclosures:
JCS 1458/2 (Copy No. 29).
JCS 1458/3 (Copy No. 27). TOP SECRET

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Richard T. Gould, Archivist

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